

1. Adjust Visual effects

As compared to previous versions of Windows, XP comes loaded with lot of eye-candy. These visual effects put a lot of strain on your system resources and drag down the overall system performance. We suggest you follow this tip if you have 256 MB or less of RAM.

For adjusting the visual effects, you need to get to the System Properties page, which can be done by pressing [Windows] + [Pause/Break], or by right-clicking on 'My Computer' and selecting 'Properties'.



The Advanced tab in System Properties

Select the 'Advanced' tab and then click on 'Settings' under the 'Performance' box. In the box that opens, select the 'Visual Effects' tab. By default, the first option is always chosen. To improve performance, select the 'Adjust for best performance' radio button. Depending on your hardware configuration, Windows will automatically tone down the visual effects. To further tweak the system, select 'Custom', and start un-checking the effects that were not automatically shut down by XP in the first step. Play around with these settings until the interface reflects an optimum balance between speed and visual appeal.



Customise XP's visual effects